

Luxpro Sues Apple For Market Domination

A Taiwanese MP3 manufacturing company called Luxpro has sued Apple in a US court for using unfair means to stamp out competition and take monopolistic control of the market. Luxpro was previously sued by Apple for making shuffle clones



Nokia Makes Symbian Open Source

Following on the footsteps of Android, Nokia has decided to transition its Symbian OS for smartphones into a free licensing model. Symbian will be available as an Open Source platform from June 2010. Windows Mobile is now the only holdout



Enter



Jon Von Tetzchner
CEO, Opera Software

Jon Von Tetzchner was in India recently and we had a two hour chat with him and Opera's India Country Manager Sagar Chandra over lunch one afternoon.

Opera 9.60 is almost out. What's new it and why is it important for India?

Other than being optimised for slower connections and also slow computers, Opera 9.60 has support for local languages such as Hindi, Tamil and Telugu to be used in the inbuilt mail client.

What part of Opera is developed in India?

A lot of the widget related work is done in Opera's office in India based out of Chandigarh. Some of the quality testing of the product also happens there.

With Opera's desktop version being free, where does the money come from?

Our income comes from our commercial browser for the mobile devices — Opera Mobile. We also have other clients who use our products — Nintendo is one example of a company that uses our browser in the Wii and also their new mobile gaming device the DSI.

Tell us more about Opera Mini and how do you promote its use in India?

India is already the third largest user of the Opera Mini browser on mobile phones. We also have tie-ups with phone manufacturers and service providers in India to carry preinstalled copies of Opera on their devices.

Will Opera ever go Open Source?

There are no plans of making Opera Open Source. We decided to make Opera free and it was a good move welcomed by people everywhere. We have a great product in our hands and we have a path for it. We believe in an open and free Web. We actively listen to the community for suggestions for the future and any issues that exist, are quickly fixed by our team.

PATENT WARS CONTINUED...

INTEL-AMD LICENCE WAR

A lot has been happening the past few months in the chip manufacturing business. While on one hand Intel's sales have been soaring, its tiny rival AMD has been struggling. Not many years ago, Intel was troubled by the rate at which AMD was eating into its profits.

Today things are a bit different. Intel still maintains its monopoly in the microprocessor business. With sales just dwindling by the day, AMD had no choice, but to take drastic steps in order to be in a position to take on Intel. Among these, was shutting down its own manufacturing plants and raking in as many investments as possible — from wherever possible.

The money did come in, in the form of Advanced Technology Investment Company (ATIC), an Abu Dhabi state-owned venture capital firm that has pledged \$2.1 billion. With this investment, ATIC will get a 55.6-per cent stake in the venture. \$700 million will be paid to AMD, which will hold the remaining stake. As per the deal, both companies will have equal representation on the board.

Doug Grose, Senior Vice President of Technology at AMD will be the CEO of the new company, while Hector Ruiz, the current chairman



of AMD will be the new chairman. Operations are planned at a new factory in New York early next year, with 1,400 employees.

Experts predict the new entity would start as a very small part of the industry, with probably around 5 per cent market share. However, in the long term, it is expected to significantly grow, with visible results expected after 2010. The new company christened Foundry Company will be a 3,000-strong entity and would own AMD's two plants in Dresden, Germany. CPUs as well as chips for other companies will be manufactured from here.

All said and done, the optimistic plans for AMD haven't gone down well with Intel, which has been vocal in questioning the deal.

Intel claims that AMD and Intel have a patent cross-licensing agreement under which AMD pays royalties to

Intel. With controversy hitting out all around this development, what is left to be seen is the implication on prices on AMD and ATI-based processors and cards. Besides, this deal is also closely watched by companies like IBM, which has placed stakes on AMD-based PCs in the future.

AMD's announcement now means that Intel is the last remaining company who both designs and manufactures chips themselves.

KILLER ANDROIDS?

ANDROID, NOW WITH A KILL SWITCH

Although the controversy of a kill switch started in the days following the launch of the Android-based phone G1